

EASTBOUND GROUP

Destination Guides

India · UAE · Sri Lanka · Nepal · Bhutan

Destination Management · Events · Incentives · Conferences

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Destination Guides

Five destinations, one team on the ground.

Every event begins with the right place. These guides give you a clear first look at each destination we operate in: what makes it distinctive, which kinds of groups it suits, when it is at its best, and what to think through early in the planning process.

Use them to compare destinations side by side, then talk to us about shaping a programme around the one that fits your objectives, your group and your season.

AT A GLANCE

Destination	Best suited for	Best months	Typical scale
India	Incentives, celebrations, conferences, cultural programmes	Oct to Mar	Small groups to large conferences
UAE	Conferences, exhibitions, launches, gala events	Nov to Mar	Boardroom to very large conventions
Sri Lanka	Incentives, celebrations, wellness and leadership retreats	Dec to Mar (west and south); Apr to Sep (east)	Small to mid-size groups
Nepal	Leadership retreats, wellness, adventure, cultural groups	Oct to Nov; Mar to May	Small to mid-size groups
Bhutan	Small incentives, retreats, VIP and milestone celebrations	Mar to May; Sep to Nov	Small, exclusive groups

BEFORE YOU PLAN

Visa rules, entry permits, fees and seasonal conditions change from year to year and vary by nationality. Treat this guide as a starting point and confirm current requirements with us at the time of planning.

India

Heritage, scale and sensory richness.

Key event cities	Delhi, Mumbai, Jaipur, Udaipur, Goa and Kerala, with Agra, Jodhpur and hill retreats as extensions
Best suited for	Incentive groups, destination celebrations, conferences, cultural programmes
Best months	October to March
Getting there	Delhi and Mumbai are the main international gateways, with strong domestic connections to heritage and leisure cities
Group scale	From small private groups to large conferences, depending on the city and venue

WHY HOLD AN EVENT HERE

India offers a breadth few destinations can match. Palace hotels, Himalayan foothills, backwater houseboats, beach resorts and world-class city hotels can all sit within a single programme. Its hospitality, craftsmanship and food give a group something memorable at every stage of the journey.

SIGNATURE EXPERIENCES

- Private dinners in palace and heritage settings, with live music and performance
- Guided heritage walks led by historians and local storytellers
- Artisan workshops: block printing, textiles, miniature painting and pottery
- Cooking classes and market visits, from street food to regional fine dining
- Sunrise and sunset experiences at forts, monuments and lakes
- Wellness sessions including yoga and Ayurveda

PLANNING CONSIDERATIONS

- Distances are large. Limit the number of cities or plan domestic flights between them
- October to March is peak season and books early, especially around wedding season and Diwali
- Heat from April to June and monsoon from June to September affect outdoor programmes
- Allow buffer time for city traffic on arrival and transfer days
- Entry requirements vary by nationality. E-visas are available for many travellers, so confirm current rules
- Plan dietary needs early. Regional menus can be adapted with notice

RESPONSIBLE PLANNING

Work with local artisans, guides and family-run properties, and choose experiences that give back to the communities that host your group.

United Arab Emirates

World-class infrastructure, desert and city in one journey.

Key event cities	Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah and Ras Al Khaimah
Best suited for	Conferences and exhibitions, incentive groups, product launches, gala events
Best months	November to March
Getting there	Major global hubs at Dubai and Abu Dhabi with extensive direct connections
Group scale	From boardroom meetings to very large conventions

WHY HOLD AN EVENT HERE

The UAE pairs modern convention infrastructure with short transfers, efficient logistics and a strong sense of safety and service. Each emirate has its own character: Dubai for energy and scale, Abu Dhabi for culture and leisure, Sharjah for museums and the arts, and Ras Al Khaimah for mountains, beaches and adventure. Indoor events work well outside the cooler months.

SIGNATURE EXPERIENCES

- Desert safari with dinner under the stars at a private camp
- Dhow cruises and waterfront dining
- Private dining in skyline venues
- Cultural visits, including Sheikh Zayed Grand Mosque in Abu Dhabi
- Leisure and theme park experiences on Yas Island
- Adventure in Ras Al Khaimah, including Jebel Jais
- Hot air balloon flights over the desert

PLANNING CONSIDERATIONS

- Summer temperatures often exceed 40°C. Favour indoor venues and evening programming from June to September
- Ramadan dates shift each year. Programming, dining and entertainment adjust accordingly
- Dress respectfully in public spaces and at religious sites
- Alcohol is served in licensed venues only
- Peak periods and major exhibitions fill hotels quickly. Book early
- Entry requirements vary by nationality

Sri Lanka

Compact, green and unexpectedly varied.

Key event cities	Colombo, Galle, Kandy, Nuwara Eliya and the hill country, Sigiriya and the cultural triangle, Yala
Best suited for	Incentive groups, celebrations, wellness and leadership retreats, small conferences
Best months	December to March (west and south coasts); April to September (east coast)
Getting there	Bandaranaike International Airport, near Colombo
Group scale	Small to mid-size groups, often in boutique properties

WHY HOLD AN EVENT HERE

An island where beaches, tea country, ancient cities and wildlife sit within a few hours of one another. Sri Lanka gives groups variety without the demands of a long multi-city itinerary, and its boutique hotel scene suits programmes that value character and personal service.

SIGNATURE EXPERIENCES

- Walking tour of Galle Fort, followed by a long lunch in a heritage setting
- Tea estate visits with tastings in the hill country
- A scenic train journey through the highlands
- Safari in Yala or another national park
- Sigiriya rock fortress at sunrise
- Seasonal whale watching on the south coast
- Ayurveda and wellness sessions, and rice and curry cooking classes

PLANNING CONSIDERATIONS

- Two monsoon seasons mean coastal conditions differ by region and month
- Winding roads make journeys slower than distances suggest
- Boutique properties have limited room counts. Book early for larger groups
- Poya (full-moon) holidays affect alcohol service and some activities
- An electronic travel authorisation is required for many nationalities. Confirm current rules

Nepal

A Himalayan backdrop and deep cultural roots.

Key event cities	Kathmandu, Pokhara, Chitwan and Nagarkot
Best suited for	Leadership retreats, wellness and adventure groups, small incentives, cultural programmes
Best months	October to November; March to May
Getting there	Tribhuvan International Airport, Kathmandu, with domestic flights or road transfers to Pokhara and Chitwan
Group scale	Small to mid-size groups

WHY HOLD AN EVENT HERE

Snow peaks, UNESCO-listed heritage in the Kathmandu Valley, lakeside Pokhara and jungle at Chitwan sit within one compact country. Nepal's spiritual and wellness traditions make it a natural choice for groups looking for reflection and meaning as well as adventure.

SIGNATURE EXPERIENCES

- Sunrise over the Himalaya from a viewpoint or a scenic mountain flight
- Heritage walks in the Kathmandu Valley, including Patan, Bhaktapur and Boudhanath
- Yoga and meditation sessions with local teachers
- Boating on Phewa Lake in Pokhara
- Jungle safari at Chitwan
- Nepali cooking workshops and craft visits

PLANNING CONSIDERATIONS

- Mountain weather can affect flights. Build buffer days into the programme
- Monsoon from June to September makes travel and views less predictable
- Venue capacity is limited for very large groups
- Road journeys are long, so plan transfer times generously
- Connectivity can be patchy outside the main cities
- Visa on arrival is available to many nationalities. Confirm current rules

Bhutan

Small, sacred and carefully protected.

Key event cities	Paro, Thimphu and Punakha
Best suited for	Small incentive groups, wellness and leadership retreats, VIP and milestone celebrations
Best months	March to May; September to November
Getting there	Paro International Airport, with limited flights operated by Drukair and Bhutan Airlines
Group scale	Small, exclusive groups

WHY HOLD AN EVENT HERE

Bhutan's approach to tourism favours high-value, low-volume travel, and that shapes the experience: quiet valleys, dzongs and monasteries, and a culture that measures progress by national happiness. It suits groups who want something exclusive, restorative and genuinely different.

SIGNATURE EXPERIENCES

- Hike to Tiger's Nest (Paro Taktsang)
- A private archery match, the national sport
- Visits to dzongs and monasteries with a local guide
- Attendance at a tshechu festival, where the calendar allows
- Farmhouse dinners and traditional hot stone baths
- Meditation sessions and textile weaving demonstrations

PLANNING CONSIDERATIONS

- A daily Sustainable Development Fee applies to most visitors, in addition to visa costs. Confirm the current rate
- Flights are limited and seats fill early. Plan and confirm well ahead
- Travel is arranged through licensed operators
- Hotels are smaller, so group size is naturally capped
- Paro and Thimphu sit above 2,000 metres. Allow time to acclimatise
- Festival periods draw crowds. Book early if timing your visit around one

Where next?

Tell us about your group and we will suggest the right fit.

If you are still weighing destinations, share your dates, group size and objectives and we will point you to the right material and the right conversation.

Email: info@eastboundgroup.com